



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

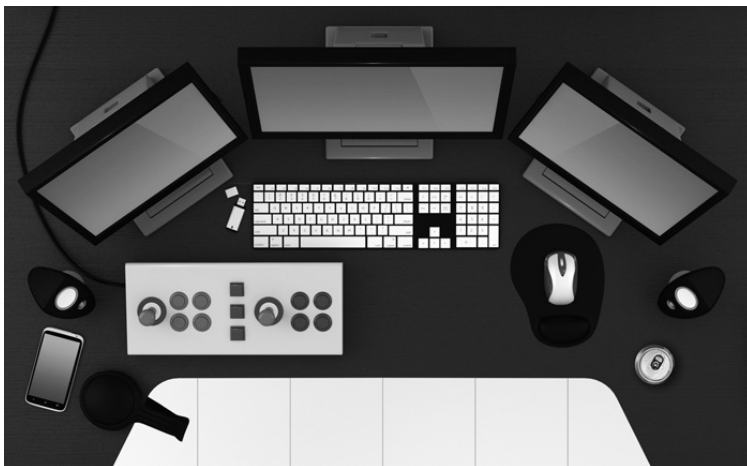
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Let's Start!

What can be done about TV violence?



Learning Outcome

Describe unusual events through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you think that what children watch on TV or in movies influences how they behave in real life? Why or why not?
- What is your opinion on video games? Do you think they are too violent? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about staying healthy.
- I can talk about what was happening when something else happened.
- I can organize points in an argument.





Let's Explore!

Sally continues to blog about **youth*** mental health. Is there anything to be done to improve it?

* "Youth" means young people.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

So, what can be done about the issue of violent cartoons for kids?

Some parents limit the amount of TV their children watch every day. Television stations show an advisory for programs that are not suitable for young children. They usually show them late at night, when most children are asleep. However, there aren't any limits on cartoons, which are usually shown in the afternoon.

Researchers in a recent study were trying to find out if "positive" cartoons would have a good effect on children. By "positive" cartoons, they meant cartoons showing characters that helped one another, shared things, and cooperated in some way. Forty children between the ages of three and five were shown positive cartoons. After watching the cartoons, the children returned to their classroom. While they were playing freely for an hour they were watched by an observer who sat in the classroom and wrote down positive things they did. They were taking turns, sharing toys, and helping each other. The children behaved better than the other groups that had not seen the positive cartoons. To sum up, this study shows that TV can educate children to be either violent or cooperative. It is impossible to stop children watching TV. Nevertheless, it might be a good idea for TV stations to show more positive children's programs and less violent ones.





Let's Practice!

Sally checked a study where children were watching different TV shows.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Circle the incorrect word. Write the correct word above to complete the sentence. Use capital letters where necessary.

1. In a recent study, resaerchers were trying to find out if programs with positive contends have a good efect on children.
2. Caracters showed good behaviors in positive cartons, like sharing and cooperating.
3. Researchers studid children's behaviors after children were waching positive cartoons.
4. Children were showing coperative behaviors after they watched positive cartons.
5. Children were not showing a cooperative atitute after they watched violen cartoons.



Let's Practice!

Sally thinks TV cartoons have a great influence on children's mental health.

Instructions: Read the text again. Circle the correct word to complete the sentence.

1. Cartoons, either positive or violent, - are showed / are shown / is shown - in the afternoon.
2. When children - were shown / is shown / were showed- positive cartoons, they showed a cooperative behavior.
3. Children who watched positive cartoons - are observed / were observed / was observed - by researchers.
4. Children - can be educated / can be educate / can be educating - by TV, either to be cooperative or violent.
5. More positive cartoons - should be showing / should be showed / should be shown - to promote better behaviors in children.





Extension Activity

Watch an English cartoon.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or visit a library. Try to find a popular English cartoon.
- Watch an episode.
- Write a short description of the episode, using the Past Continuous and Simple Past tenses.
- Discuss the episode with a partner. Share your opinion of it.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I watch an English cartoon.

☐ ☐

I write a short description of the episode.

☐ ☐

I discuss the episode with a partner.

☐ ☐

I share my opinion about an English cartoon.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to limit** (verb): to restrict; to create restrictions
e.g. Some parents limit the amount of TV their children watch every day.
- **advisory** (noun): an announcement that tells the public about the contents of a television program
e.g. Television stations show an advisory.
- **to share** (verb): to divide or distribute in equal parts
e.g. Children were sharing toys.
- **to cooperate** (verb): to work together for a common benefit
e.g. Cartoon characters cooperated in some way.
- **to take turns** (verb): to do things in an organized way, with the participation of all members in a group
e.g. Children were taking turns.
- **cooperative** (adjective): showing mutual work, with benefits for everybody
e.g. TV can educate children to be either violent or cooperative.





Learning Points

The Past Continuous Tense and the Simple Past Tense

You use the *Past Continuous* tense to talk about an action that was happening at a time before now.

You use the *Simple Past* to talk about a finished past action.

You can use the *Past Continuous* to:

- Describe the atmosphere at a particular time in the past.

For example:

*The children **were laughing** and the birds **were singing** in the park. A woman **was looking** for her phone, which she dropped somewhere ...*

- Describe an action that was interrupted by another event or action.

For example:

*While they **were playing** freely for an hour they were watched by an observer.*

The form of the *Past Continuous* is:

Subject + *was/were* + verb *-ing*

You use the *Simple Past* to talk about a shorter action or event that happened in the middle of, or interrupted, the longer action.

*They were taking turns, sharing toys, and helping each other when **the researchers came into the room.***

Examples:

- *Researchers in a recent study were trying to find out if "positive" cartoons would have a good effect on children.*
- *While they were playing freely for an hour, they were watched by an observer who sat in the classroom and wrote down positive things they did.*
- *They were taking turns, sharing toys, and helping each other.*

The Passive Voice

You use the active voice when you want the 'doer' of the action to be the subject.

You use the passive voice when you want the 'receiver' of the action to be the subject.

Active sentence = *TV (subject) **affects** kids' sleep, weight, grades, behavior and more (object).*

Passive sentence = *Kids' sleep, weight, grades, behavior and more (subject) **are affected***





Learning Points

by TV (object) .

It is not always necessary to mention the object in a passive sentence.

You make the passive form of a verb by using tenses of the *be* verb followed by the past participle.

The Simple Present passive form is:

am/are/is + past participle

For example:

*Children between the ages of three and five **are shown** positive cartoons.*

The Simple Past passive form is:

was/were + past participle

For example:

*Children between the ages of three and five **were shown** positive cartoons.*

You can use **modal verbs** in the passive voice, too.

You use modal verbs to add meaning to other verbs.

They come before the dictionary form (Infinitive without 'to') of the main verb.

Modal verbs can add meaning connected with possibility, certainty or obligation.

For example:

*Children between the ages of three and five **should be shown** positive cartoons.*

Here the sentence now has an additional meaning of possibility, thanks to the modal verb *should*.

Examples:

- *What can be done about the issue of violent cartoons for kids?*
- *There aren't any limits on cartoons, which are usually shown in the afternoon.*
- *Forty children between the ages of three and five were shown positive cartoons.*
- *They were watched by an observer who sat in the classroom and wrote down positive things they did.*

